

Step 1: Connect the Printer to Your Computer

Depending on your printer type, connect it using one of the two methods below:

Option A: USB Connection (Direct)

1. Place the printer near your computer and plug its power cable into an electrical outlet. Turn the printer on.
2. Plug the square end (USB Type-B) of the printer cable into the back of the printer.
3. Plug the rectangular end (USB Type-A) into an available USB port directly on your computer.

Option B: Network Connection (Wi-Fi or Ethernet)

- **Wi-Fi:** On the printer's control panel, navigate to the network/wireless settings, select your Wi-Fi network, and enter the password.
- **Ethernet:** Connect an Ethernet cable from the back of the printer directly into a LAN port on your internet router or network switch.

Step 2: Install the Printer Drivers

Most modern operating systems will automatically detect the printer and install basic drivers, but installing the official manufacturer driver ensures all features work properly.

Windows 10 & 11

1. Click the **Start Menu** and open **Settings** (gear icon).
2. Go to **Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners**.
3. Click **Add device**. Windows will scan for connected or network printers.
4. Once your printer appears in the list, click **Add device** next to it.

Note: If Windows doesn't find it automatically, visit the manufacturer's website (e.g., HP, Canon, Epson), enter your printer model number, and download the official driver software suite.

macOS

1. Click the **Apple Menu** in the top left corner and select **System Settings** (or System Preferences).
2. Scroll down and click **Printers & Scanners**.
3. Click the **Add Printer, Scanner, or Fax...** button (or the + icon).
4. Select your printer from the list and click **Add**. macOS will automatically download the correct software.

Step 3: Print a Test Page

Verifying the installation by printing a test page ensures that the computer and printer are communicating successfully.

On Windows

1. In the **Printers & scanners** menu (from Step 2), click on your newly installed printer.
2. Click on **Printer properties** (a new window will pop up).
3. Under the **General** tab, look at the bottom right and click the **Print Test Page** button.

On macOS

1. In the **Printers & Scanners** menu, click on your printer.
2. Click on **Open Print Queue...**
3. In the top menu bar, click on **Printer** and select **Print Test Page**.

Troubleshooting Tips

- **Status is "Offline":** Ensure the printer is turned on, awake, and securely connected to the same Wi-Fi network as your computer.
- **Spooler Error:** If the print job gets stuck, type "Services" in the Windows search bar, find **Print Spooler**, right-click it, and select **Restart**.